

Word Play

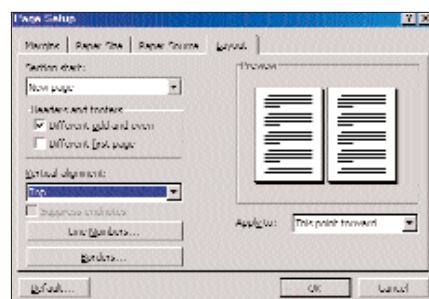
Surprise! Microsoft Word is a page layout software too. Here's how you can use it to create some of the most stunning pages

Got a project to submit or a report to send out? Does your teacher or boss insist on neatness and consistency? You could pay your local STD-ISD-PCO-Xerox-Computer Layout guy to come up with a snazzy output in Pagemaker over a day or two—or you could do it yourself in a few hours and impress the hell out of anybody. It's not difficult at all and you don't need any special software. Just find out how many more intricacies Word is capable of. You'll be pleasantly surprised!

Page formatting

To begin with, construct the page as you would want the final output. This goes slightly beyond setting the page size and margins. From the Page Setup dialog box, you can specify the layout of the document—whether you want a different first page (for instance, as a cover sheet) or align text and graphics in the centre of the page. All settings can be specified for the entire document or only for a section. This is particularly useful for inserting items such as graphs and illustrations in the document. You can even add colourful borders to the document.

Another aspect of the page construc-

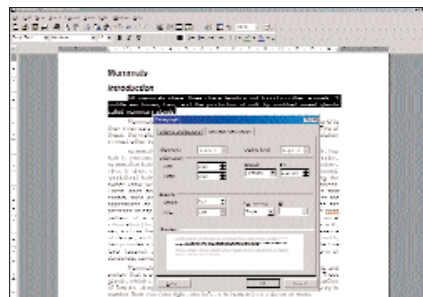


Specifying document layout in Word

tion involves headers and footers. From the Page Setup dialog, you can specify header and footer positioning. You insert text and images from **View > Header and Footer**. These are usually used for including the name of the document, page numbers, and so on.

Paragraph formatting

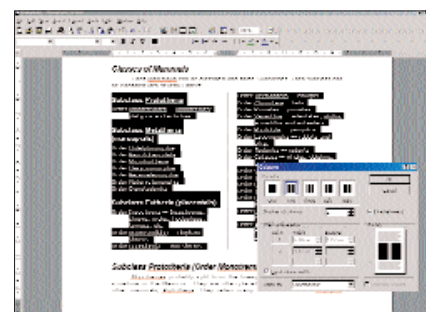
Formatting paragraphs becomes very important for presentation as well as organising your material. Open **Format > Paragraph** to begin. From here you can set the paragraph alignment, the text



Formatting paragraphs in Word

indentation, and the spacing within, before and after the paragraph. You can even format the first line differently.

Some very useful features are available under the Line and Page Breaks tab. These options will make sure your document never looks shabby. 'Window/Orphan control' will make sure that the paragraph doesn't begin at the end of a page or doesn't end with a single word. 'Keep with next' will cause the current and next paragraphs to always appear on the same page. This is very useful for headings. 'Keep lines together' will make sure the entire paragraph always appears on a single page, unless it



Formatting text in columns

is too large. This is very useful for comments, excerpts, etc. 'Page break before' will move the paragraph to the next page—useful for beginning new sections. This is better than inserting a page break manually, since the break will always move with the paragraph.

Flow text in columns, say, for a list. Select the text and click on **Format > Columns**. Now select the number of columns. You can set them to be of equal or different sizes. Adjust the space between the columns and choose whether there should be a line in between.

Tabs are useful for inserting text exactly where it should appear—a tab defines the starting position of the text. You can have any number of tabs in a line, and the text between two tabs is separated by a [Tab]. In Word 2000, you can automatically set a tab by double-clicking anywhere on the page. You can manually set tabs from **Format > Tabs** or by dragging the tab mark on the ruler.

You can directly choose the number of columns by clicking on the Columns icon on the Standard toolbar.

